Luxe PDRN Toner Pads: the short version

Product 2. Prices as of 2026-10-31.

1. In one sentence

A jar of 140 soaked gel pads you lay on your face for 5 minutes like a mini mask, then wipe with: a gentle hydration (water) step that makes skin look plumper and dewier for hours.

2. What it is, in detail

- **Format:** a pink 200 g tub of 140 round pads (7 cm, about a coffee mug's base) in a wobbly pink gel, with tweezers. A slippery **gel side** for masking, a **fabric side** for wiping. Made in Korea.
- **Price:** $59.95 on the brand site = **$0.43 a pad**. Lasts 70 days at two a day.
- **Smell:** no fragrance listed; almost none, say buyers of the identical Anua pad.

Main ingredient	What it is	What it does here
Water, glycerin, butylene glycol, glycereth-26	The base, about 80–90% of the pad	**Humectants** (water-grabbers, like a sponge). Pull water into the top layer of skin
Niacinamide	Vitamin B3, 4th on the list	The one well-proven ingredient. In studies (at 5%) it softened the look of fine lines and dark spots over 4–12 weeks. Amount here not stated
Adenosine	A natural molecule	A Korean-approved anti-wrinkle ingredient. Small amount
PDRN ("sodium DNA")	Small pieces of salmon DNA	The headline ingredient. About 0.01% (100 ppm, parts per million). A light surface moisturiser
Hyaluronic acid, peptides, collagen	Water-holders and protein pieces	Tiny amounts. Collagen on the skin does not become your collagen
Plant extracts (neem, turmeric, kakadu plum, soy ferment)	Small amounts	Antioxidant (protects from sun and pollution) and soothing claims, mostly lab-based

Not in it: exfoliating acids, retinol (vitamin A), vitamin C, fragrance, drying alcohol, oils or ceramides (barrier fats).

3. How this kind of product works

- **Skin basics.** The top layer is a "brick wall": dead cells are the bricks, fats the mortar. This is the **skin barrier**; it keeps water in and irritants out. Pads only touch this layer. Wrinkles and sagging start deeper.
- **Hydration vs moisture.** Hydration = water. Moisture = the oils that seal it in. This pad adds water but no seal, so it **needs a moisturiser on top**.
- **Toner** = any watery liquid used after washing. Three kinds: **astringent** (alcohol, drying), **exfoliating** (acids that loosen dead cells) and **hydrating**. **Luxe is hydrating**, the kind dermatologists (skin doctors) recommend after 50.
- **Toner pads** = toner pre-soaked into pads in a jar. Types: exfoliating, hydrating, **gel** (sits flat like a mini sheet mask), dual-sided, PDRN, retinol and DIY. Luxe is a **dual-sided hydrating gel PDRN pad**.
- **PDRN** (polydeoxyribonucleotide) is DNA, mostly from salmon sperm. **Injected**, it helps wounds heal. On the skin, the pieces are far too big to get in, like a football through a letterbox. Dr Dray (dermatologist) doubts PDRN products "do anything above and beyond moisturize the skin".

- **Why it's trending:** Kim Kardashian's "salmon sperm facial" injections, Korean skincare ("K-beauty") and "glass skin" (very smooth, dewy skin). Online interest in PDRN rose about 610% in a year.

4. How it's used, and with what

The steps:

1. Wash your face. Pat almost dry.
2. Lift out one pad with the tweezers. Close the lid at once.
3. Lay the **gel side** on a cheek or forehead for **5 minutes**.
4. Turn it over and **gently** sweep the fabric side over the face, avoiding eyes and lips. Never scrub.
5. Pat in the rest. Wait a minute, then **moisturiser**; in the morning, **sunscreen** last.

Or: wipe only (30 seconds), or mask only (calming).

Step	Morning	Night
1	Rinse or gentle cleanser	Remove makeup, then gentle cleanser
2	**Luxe pad**	**Luxe pad**
3	Optional serum	Optional retinol some nights
4	Moisturiser	Richer moisturiser
5	Sunscreen SPF 30+, then makeup	—

- **Pairs well with:** a ceramide moisturiser, sunscreen, retinol (the pad adds no sting), vitamin C serum, makeup.
- **Be careful with:** acid pads or scrubs the same day; prescription creams for eczema (itchy, dry patches) or rosacea (long-lasting redness): ask the doctor.
- **Don't:** reuse a pad, leave it on 20–30 minutes, or put makeup on while wet (it rolls into crumbs, called **pilling**).

5. Who it's for

Good fit: dry, dehydrated (tight, dull) or normal skin; people who can't use retinol, acids or fragrance; anyone wanting a glow before makeup.

How needs change after 50 and 60. Menopause lowers estrogen, and skin changes:

Change after 50	Can the pad help?
Dryness: "probably the most striking change" (Dr Dray)	**Yes, its main strength**, with a moisturiser
Weaker barrier; old products start to sting	Partly: no acids, fragrance or alcohol
Dullness (dead cells pile up)	Yes, short term
Fine lines	Plumps them for hours
Collagen loss (about 30% in 5 years), crepey skin	No real change
Age spots	Slowly, maybe (niacinamide), only with daily sunscreen
Sagging, jowls (bone and fat change)	No

After 60, skin is thinner still: **press rather than wipe**, use a richer cream; the 5-minute mask suits best.

Not for: fish allergy (salmon DNA) or soy allergy; vegans; very oily or acne-prone skin; anyone wanting lifting or firming; tight budgets.

6. The problems it solves

Problem	Why it happens	How this product helps (or doesn't)
Dry, tight skin	Less oil and water-holding after menopause	**Helps**: a dose of water, then sealed with cream
Dull, "tired" skin	Slower cell turnover; rough surface	Helps for hours. An exfoliant does more long term
Fine lines, crepey skin	Collagen loss; sun damage	Plumps lines for hours. Doesn't firm
Dark spots, uneven tone	Years of sun	A little, over 4–12 weeks, with daily sunscreen
Skin that stings with "actives" (strong ingredients)	Fewer barrier fats with age	No acids, retinol or fragrance. Patch test still
Rough texture	Dead-cell build-up, dryness	Softens a little. **Doesn't exfoliate**
Cakey makeup	Foundation clings to dry flakes	Smoother, dewier base, if you wait before makeup
Too many steps	Confusing routines	Covers toner and mask, not moisturiser or sunscreen
Money wasted on hype	Big promises	"A nice hydrating mask, not a miracle"
Sagging, jowls	Bone and fat loss	**Doesn't help**

7. How it compares with competitors

Product	Price	What's different
Luxe PDRN Toner Pads	$59.95 / 140 ($0.43 a pad)	Biggest jar; marketed to women 40+
Anua PDRN 100 Glow Pad	$22–23 / 60 ($0.37–0.38)	**The same 45 ingredients**, cheaper per pad, smaller jar
Medicube PDRN Pink Collagen Gel Pad	$26.14 / 70 ($0.37)	Best-known brand; 100× less PDRN; has retinol
Biodance Caviar PDRN Dual Gel Pad	$24.09 / 60 ($0.40)	10× more PDRN; exfoliating side with acids
VT PDRN Tension Toner Pad	$22.75 / 60 ($0.38)	Plant (ginseng) PDRN; adds ceramides and shea
Glow Recipe PDRN+ Toner Pads	$30.00 / 60 ($0.50)	"Vegan PDRN"; soothing centella; dearest per pad

What makes Luxe different: the biggest jar, a gentle formula (no acids, retinol, fragrance or alcohol), and a "mask then wipe" habit aimed at women over 40. The recipe itself is Anua's, sold cheaper per pad there.

8. What users say

No independent Luxe reviews exist yet, so this is the identical Anua pad and close rivals.

Biggest problems before: dry skin after menopause; dullness; fine lines; skin that reacts to retinol and acids; makeup clinging to dry patches; PDRN products that "didn't live up to the hype".

How it solved them: instant water. Of 73 Anua reviews, 38 say "hydrating", 25 mention glow, 19 use it as a mask, 12 say makeup goes on better. A few report softer fine lines over time. None mention dark spots fading.

Main complaints: too wet, sticky or "goopy"; pilling; the jar leaks and is bulky; confusing two sides; the glow fades; PDRN seen as marketing.

Other feedback: rare but real reactions (rashes, peeling, burning eyes). People cut pads in half, chill them in the fridge, use them on the neck and hands. Some call toner pads wasteful.

Quotes:

- *"my 50 year old skin feels amazing"* (Anua pad, age 50)
- *"These pads are super saturated with quality skin care ingredients that cool the skin"* (Anua pad, age 51–55)
- *"Right after, my skin felt hydrated, looked glowy, but the glow fades after a few hours."* (Anua pad, over 40)
- *"regular use maintains long term hydration of fine lines."* (Anua pad)
- *"It hydrates my skin, calms redness and it's pefect under makeup."* (Anua pad)
- *"These pads always make my skin peel and also peel under makeup."* (Anua pad, dry skin)
- *"I'm completely flummoxed by the two sided pad"* (Anua pad)
- *"Not overly dramatic, but noticeable."* (JiYu pads, 50+)
- *"They do seem to moisturize in the short term but haven't noticed any change in my skin. I guess nothing is magic."* (Mediheal Collagen pad)

Based on: 326 reviews and comments (73 Anua, 136 rival pads, 110 category, 7 Luxe page testimonials); Anua averages 4.8 stars from 124 Ulta reviews.

9. Words to know

Term	Meaning
Toner pad	Pads pre-soaked in a watery liquid, in a jar
Humectant	A water-grabbing ingredient (glycerin, hyaluronic acid)
Skin barrier	The top "brick wall" that keeps water in
Hydration	Water in the skin; "dehydrated" = short of water
PDRN / sodium DNA	Salmon DNA pieces; the trend ingredient
Niacinamide	Vitamin B3; evens tone slowly
Exfoliate	Remove dead skin cells, with acids or rubbing
Glass skin / dewy	Very smooth, fresh, shiny skin
Pilling	Layers rolling into crumbs under makeup
Patch test	Trying a product on a small area for 2–3 days first
Crepey skin	Thin, crinkled skin like crepe paper
Retinol	Vitamin A cream; the best-proven anti-ageing ingredient, but can sting

10. What you can and can't say on camera

- **Can say:** "a gentle, fragrance-free, acid-free hydrating gel pad"; "skin looks plumper and dewier right after"; "use it as a 5-minute mini mask".
- **Can say:** "contains niacinamide, which can help skin tone look more even over weeks"; "the science on PDRN in skincare is still early".
- **Can't say:** "repairs cells", "rebuilds or boosts collagen", "lifts", "firms", "fades dark spots in 4 weeks", "clinically proven", "same as clinic injections".
- **Can't say:** "exfoliates", "vitamin C", "99% PDRN", "vegan", "hypoallergenic", or quote test numbers like "125% more hydration".
- **Always say:** "Allergic to fish? Ask your doctor first."